

NEGOTIATION DRAFT — MAY 2026

The Mutual Step-Back Agreement

Merged Executive Draft v4.0

Step-Back/Earn-Back Operational Edition with Three Core Swaps

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Source Document Concordance

Framework for Reciprocal Stabilization v3.2 — MVC backbone, three-tier breach, escrow architecture, survival core, step-back/earn-back mechanics. (Sections I, II, V, VIII; Annexes A–E)

Gulf Stability Accord v1.5 — Three Core Swaps, Core Triad governance, direct Swiss-Omani arbitration, five-channel verification, 30-day sprint. (Sections III, IV, V, VII, VIII)

Gulf Stability Accord v1.0 — Established Operational Nomenclature provisions. (Section III)

The Step Forward Accord v2.0 — Anti-inflationary release controls, Non-Humiliation Doctrine, synchronized announcement strategy, face-saving architecture. (Sections XI, XV; Preamble)

Section I — The Problem and The Solution

1.1 The Zero-Sum Trap

The United States and Iran are trapped in a zero-sum dynamic. Washington demands nuclear commitments before sanctions relief. Tehran demands economic benefits before nuclear concessions. Neither can move first without appearing to capitulate. The result: a costly deadlock benefiting no one. After eleven weeks of military confrontation, both sides have exhausted the military escalation ladder and returned to the negotiating table. Neither side can move first without appearing to capitulate. Washington cannot lift sanctions before verified nuclear constraints; Tehran cannot surrender sovereign nuclear material directly to its adversary. The direct negotiation format has produced only deadlock, escalating threats, and cycles of confrontation.

1.2 The Solution: Synchronized Stabilization

A Synchronized Stabilization Arrangement in which both parties move simultaneously. Every Iranian commitment triggers a corresponding US commitment on the same clock cycle. Verification is shared. Benefits are front-loaded from Day One. The arrangement is classified as an Executive Operational Arrangement — not a treaty, not a binding compact, not a permanent obligation. It is an operational protocol between governments exercising their respective executive authorities. This reduces constitutional challenges and enables executive activation without immediate legislative ratification. Implementation occurs only through existing lawful authorities available to each party.

The architecture operates through three layers: Layer 1 is the Minimum Viable Configuration (Backbone) — ceasefire, enrichment freeze, humanitarian corridor, and \$250M tranche. This operates independently of all other modules and survives total suspension. Layer 2 is the Core Political Instrument — the diplomatic skeleton containing principles, reciprocal commitments, governance, and dispute resolution. Layer 3 is the Technical Annexes — operational detail on nuclear verification, maritime governance, economic escrow, cyber resilience, and shock absorption. These can evolve without reopening the political core.

1.3 What Each Side Can Claim

Both claims are factually accurate. Neither undermines the other. This dual defensibility is the structural feature that makes the framework survive domestic political scrutiny in both capitals.

Dimension	Iran Can Claim	United States Can Claim
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Nuclear Sovereignty	"We preserved sovereignty, NPT rights, and enrichment at 3.67%. We moved as equals, not as supplicants."	"We removed weapons-grade uranium from Iranian territory. We capped enrichment. We got IAEA inside every facility."
Economic Wins	"We secured \$250M immediate humanitarian relief, banking reconnection, and a pathway to sanctions relief."	"We achieved verified nuclear constraints without paying upfront. All relief is conditional and reversible."
Maritime	"We secured co-governance of Hormuz transit and US blockade removal."	"We achieved freedom of navigation with verified Iranian small-craft stand-down."
Strategic Position	"We demonstrated that resistance diplomacy produces results."	"We demonstrated that American leadership — going first — can produce verifiable security gains."

Section II — Minimum Viable Configuration (Backbone)

The MVC is not a fallback. It is the backbone. Everything else layers on top of it. The MVC consists of four elements that operate independently of all other modules and survive total suspension. They constitute a standalone humanitarian arrangement under UN auspices.

#	Element	Specification
1	72-Hour Auto-Renewing Ceasefire	Omani-facilitated military hotline. Renews at Hour 71 if compliance telemetry is operational. Neither party may disable without 30 days' notice to the UN Secretary-General.
2	Humanitarian Corridor	Zero-fee Hormuz transit for medicine, food, medical equipment, and UN supplies. Survives all disputes. Legally non-divertible.
3	60% Enrichment Freeze	Verified by IAEA Online Enrichment Monitors within 72 hours. The central gate: all downstream benefits are contingent on this confirmation.
4	\$250M Humanitarian Tranche	Released via Swiss escrow to UN OCHA upon signature. Non-reversible. Sole disbursement authority rests with UN OCHA/WHO.

2.1 If the Framework Fails

Even if all other modules collapse, these four elements continue. They constitute a standalone humanitarian arrangement under UN auspices. If the full framework is rejected, negotiators can

still agree on the MVC alone, creating a 90-day stabilization window. The MVC continues regardless of communications status, leadership incapacity, or formal diplomatic rupture.

2.2 Quiet Extension

Unless either party submits a written non-renewal notice 30 days before expiry, the framework extends automatically for 90 days under identical terms. Maximum two consecutive extensions (180 days total). After two, the system automatically pivots: either Strategic Patience Mode activates, preserving the MVC and all humanitarian corridors while freezing progression timers, or the framework drops exclusively to the MVC backbone, requiring formal successor negotiation for reactivation. This ensures the pressure to negotiate remains alive and prevents indefinite coasting in a temporary freeze state.

2.3 Telemetry Rule

Every operative commitment must be expressible as a sensor reading, a data feed, a physical lock confirmation, or a financial transaction record. If a commitment cannot be verified by a neutral technical system, it does not belong in the operational text. When both sides can point to independent sensor data and agree on what it means, the political framing becomes a secondary concern.

Section III — The Three Core Swaps

The GSA Framework replaces the complexity of thirty micro-incentives with three macro-swaps that capture 90% of the value with 10% of the paperwork. Each swap is symmetrical: for every Iranian commitment, there is a corresponding US commitment of equivalent strategic value, activated simultaneously and verified by the Core Triad. Neither side subsidizes the other. Both sides profit from de-escalation.

Swap	Iran Delivers	US Delivers	Verification
1: Humanitarian & Banking	Freeze 60% enrichment at Natanz and Fordow, verified by IAEA within 72 hours via OLEM and physical inspection.	\$250M Swiss escrow tranche for humanitarian goods (medicine, food, agricultural inputs) AND connect Bank Melli to SWIFT strictly for humanitarian clearing (MT 103/202 messages only).	IAEA confirms freeze via OLEM (continuous); Swiss FOCBS confirms escrow release (real-time); SWIFT confirms Bank Melli messaging activation (within 48 hours of freeze confirmation).

2: Maritime	IRGC-Navy stands down small-craft harassment in the Hormuz transit corridor. IRGC fast-attack craft withdraw to 5nm from designated transit lanes. No vessel interdiction, no drone overflight of commercial shipping, no mine-laying.	Completely lifts the commercial naval blockade on Bandar Abbas, Bandar Imam Khomeini, and Chabahar. Iranian-flagged commercial vessels may load and unload without interference. Three pre-verified commercial vessels per week permitted to exit the Persian Gulf initially, scaling to unrestricted commercial access by Sprint completion.	Omani naval observers log IRGC craft positions (continuous); Lloyd's List AIS tracking confirms vessel movements; PG-MSC observation vessels patrol transit corridor. US Navy withdrawal confirmed via 5th Fleet AIS broadcast and Omani observation.
3: Industrial Log	Exports its entire 60% enriched uranium stockpile to Oman for IAEA dual-lock custody. Transfer verified by mass spectrometry, continuous CCTV monitoring, and satellite surveillance. All enrichment centrifuges above 3.67% are idled and sealed under IAEA tamper-evident protocols.	Issues an immediate OFAC waiver allowing Iran to import commercial Boeing aviation safety parts (engines, landing gear, avionics, navigation systems) for Iranian civilian aircraft (Boeing 747, 727, and Airbus fleets). Safety-of-flight items are fast-tracked with 48-hour auto-approval.	IAEA confirms stockpile custody via mass spectrometry and dual-lock seals; Oman provides physical custody confirmation; satellite surveillance confirms transfer convoy. OFAC confirms waiver issuance within 24 hours of verified stockpile transfer; Boeing confirms parts export authorization.

3.1 Strategic Value of Each Swap

Swap 1: Humanitarian & Banking

Iran: Receives immediate, non-reversible liquidity and the first step toward banking normalization — both visible, sovereignty-preserving wins. The \$250M tranche is protected by the Humanitarian Firewall: it cannot be frozen, clawed back, or subject to rollback under any breach scenario. Bank Melli's SWIFT access is restricted to humanitarian MT codes; any non-humanitarian messaging triggers automatic suspension review by the Swiss FOCBS.

United States: Secures a verified halt to weapons-grade enrichment and IAEA presence inside Iranian facilities within 72 hours — an irreversible security gain.

Swap 2: Maritime

Iran: Regains commercial port access enabling resumption of petrochemical and non-oil exports worth an estimated \$2 billion annually — an immediate, visible economic win. Hormuz reopening restores Iranian influence as a coastal sovereign while gaining a permanent voting seat on the PG-MS C Council.

United States: Secures open Hormuz transit, normalizing global energy markets and reducing insurance rates from 1.5% to 0.15% of hull value. The synchronized blockade lift occurs within a 60-second window on Day 7, 0000 GMT. Neither side moves first; the Omani facilitating state confirms simultaneous declaration. If either side fails to move, the other maintains position and the Sprint enters a 48-hour clarification window.

Swap 3: Industrial Log

Iran: Restores airworthiness to its civilian fleet, which has suffered 18 fatal accidents since 2018 due to maintenance restrictions — a direct, life-saving benefit visible to every Iranian citizen. The OFAC waiver covers aviation safety parts only. It does not authorize military aircraft components, dual-use technology, or weapons systems. The waiver is conditional on continued IAEA access and expires automatically if enrichment above 3.67% resumes.

United States: Removes weapons-grade uranium from Iranian territory to neutral third-party custody — the single most important non-proliferation achievement available without a comprehensive treaty. This creates a verifiable zero-breakout pathway: through phased verification, centrifuge mothballing, stockpile transfer to third-party custody, and continuous IAEA monitoring, the framework aims to eliminate Iran's capacity to produce weapons-grade uranium without detection.

3.2 Synchronization Rules

Neither side moves alone. Every Iranian commitment triggers a corresponding US commitment on the same clock cycle. The Sprint uses target windows that dramatically improve survivability: "within 7 days" becomes "Target window: 7-10 days." "Within 72 hours" becomes "Target window: 48-96 hours." Only the 60% enrichment freeze verification remains "within 72 hours" because it is the Sprint's central deliverable.

3.3 Aggregate Value

Category	Iranian Value (USD)	US Value
Swap 1: Humanitarian & Banking	\$250M immediate liquidity + SWIFT access	IAEA inside Natanz; enrichment freeze confirmed

Swap Maritime	2:	\$2B annual port access; Hormuz reopening	Energy market stabilization; insurance normalization (~\$735M reinsurance access)
Swap Industrial Log	3:	\$320M aviation safety; fleet restoration	HEU in neutral custody; zero-breakout pathway locked
Total Value	Sprint	\$2.57B+ immediate; \$10B+ over 5 years	Irreversible non-proliferation gains + \$1B+ commercial wins

Section IV — Core Triad Governance

4.1 The Core Triad

The GSA Framework concentrates day-to-day authority in three entities with the most direct operational roles, eliminating administrative logjam while preserving comprehensive verification coverage:

Entity	Domain	Core Function
Oman	Maritime & Physical Custody	All maritime deconfliction, hotlines, physical nuclear stockpile custody, naval encounter facilitation, Hormuz transit oversight. Hosts the Joint Coordination Secretariat backup site and all hotline operations.
Switzerland	Financial Verification	All financial escrows, banking telemetry, asset verification, sanctions relief monitoring. Administers the Swiss Financial Cell and the IHTA toll revenue trust.
IAEA	Nuclear Verification	Raw technical nuclear monitoring, enrichment verification, facility inspection, HEU chain-of-custody certification. Operates the Oman custody facility.

4.2 Emergency Backchannels

Qatar, Pakistan, and the UN Appointee are removed from day-to-day oversight. They are retained only as emergency backchannels if the Triad gridlocks. Qatar provides emergency liquidity bridging. Pakistan convenes high-level crisis summits. The UN Appointee maintains the emergency diplomatic channel.

4.3 Direct Swiss-Omani Arbitration

The Framework replaces multi-tier tie-breaking voting systems with Direct Co-Arbitration by Core Triad members. This eliminates great-power UN politics from active-warzone dispute resolution and ensures binding rulings within 48 hours.

Article IHTA-5: Direct Co-Arbitration Architecture

Primary Resolution: All maritime and enforcement disputes are resolved by consensus between the two permanent co-chairs (the United States and Iran). The GCC rotating chair serves in an advisory capacity only and holds no veto or tie-breaking authority.

Deadlock Trigger: If the US and Iran co-chairs deadlock on a maritime or enforcement vote, the issue automatically triggers Direct Co-Arbitration:

- **Oman rules on all naval and maritime disputes** (transit allocation, encounter protocols, blockade enforcement questions, territorial water claims) within 48 hours.
- **Switzerland rules on all financial and escrow disputes** (tranche releases, asset verification, sanctions relief questions, banking telemetry disputes) within 48 hours.

Binding Ruling: The arbitrator's ruling is binding on both parties and must be issued within 48 hours based purely on the principle of trade continuity. No great-power politics, no UN Security Council dynamics, no multi-observer consensus requirements.

48-Hour Clock: The 48-hour countdown begins at the moment of formal deadlock declaration by the Joint Coordination Secretariat. Failure to issue a ruling within 48 hours triggers automatic fallback: status quo ante prevails, and both parties must continue existing operational protocols until arbitration resumes.

4.4 Joint Coordination Secretariat

The Framework consolidates all governance functions into one Joint Coordination Secretariat (Geneva, with Muscat maritime desk) containing specialized subcells: Political Coordination Cell; Maritime Operations Cell; Nuclear Verification Cell; Financial Operations Cell; Communications Cell; and Crisis Response Cell.

The Secretariat operates from two sites: Primary Site in Geneva (Political Coordination, Financial Operations, Crisis Response, Communications Cells) and Backup Site in Muscat (Maritime Operations Cell, all hotline operations, regional liaison functions). If the Geneva site becomes inoperable, all functions fail over to Muscat within 4 hours. Both sites maintain 24/7 staffing with minimum 2 duty officers at all times. During crisis periods, staffing scales to minimum 6 officers per site.

4.5 Institutional Binding Doctrine

All obligations, commitments, and benefits established under this framework bind the sovereign institutions of the signatory states — the Government of the United States of America and the Government of the Islamic Republic of Iran — not individual officeholders, administrations, or leadership. Successor governments, administrations, and leadership inherit all rights and

obligations automatically upon assumption of constitutional authority. No successor government may claim that its predecessor's commitments are void due to transition.

Section V — Verification and Breach System

5.1 Five-Channel Verification Convergence

The Framework uses five independent verification channels. No single channel triggers snapback. Compliance requires convergence of at least three channels. Breach requires two or more channels confirming non-compliance after a 72-hour clarification window.

Channel	Method	Administrator	Frequency
1: IAEA Technical	OLEM, satellite imagery, seismic monitoring	IAEA	Continuous real-time
2: Human Inspection	IAEA physical inspectors, neutral observers	IAEA + Oman	Daily during Sprint; weekly thereafter
3: Financial	Escrow transaction monitoring, banking surveillance	Switzerland	Real-time transaction
4: Maritime	AIS tracking, Lloyd's List, PG-MSC observation vessels	Oman + PG-MSC Secretariat	Continuous AIS; daily Lloyd's reports
5: Open Source	Commercial satellite, social media, trade data	Independent analysts	Weekly compilation

Convergence Protocol: Two-channel compliance requires neutral (Omani) review. Three-channel compliance triggers automatic benefit activation. Four-channel compliance triggers Sprint Phase acceleration. Five-channel compliance triggers Sprint completion bonus.

5.2 Three-Tier Breach System

Only deliberate hostile violations trigger suspension. Accidents, technical glitches, force majeure, and miscommunication do not constitute breach. This system replaces the JCPOA's catastrophic "snapback" model with graduated, proportional responses.

Tier	Definition	Response
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Technical	De minimis exceeded <0.5%; procedural violations; clerical errors; equipment malfunction; minor proxy ceasefire violation.	72-hour (or 7-day diplomatic) resolution; no benefit reduction; +0.5 CIS procedural penalty. Daily reporting until cleared. No relief suspension. Proxy coalitions remain active.
Material	Confirmed enrichment above ceiling; fissile diversion; unauthorized centrifuge installation; UF6 diversion to undeclared location; sustained proxy attacks after warning; significant non-compliance affecting one module; delays beyond target windows.	25% reduction in future tranches; 30-day remediation; earn-back pathway available; affected module paused; other modules continue; +2.0 CIS penalty; enhanced escrow freeze mechanism activated; unannounced inspections; daily monitoring.
Hostile	Active weapons research; material transferred to non-state actors; intentional breach with escalatory intent; nuclear weapons program activity; military attack; state-level military attack by either party.	50% reduction; conditional modules suspended; emergency consultation; 10-50% rollback (not snapback); Tier 3 modules suspended; Reconstitution Conference within 30 days.

5.3 No Snapback — Graduated Step-Back Only

The Framework rejects the JCPOA's "snapback" model, which proved catastrophic in 2018. Instead, it employs graduated step-back: small penalties for small violations, with proportional responses rather than nuclear options. Critical design principle: penalties are percentage reductions in future tranches, not clawbacks of already-released funds. Released funds stay released. This means Iran never loses what it has already received, creating irreversible ratchets that favor continued compliance.

Compliance Incentive Score (CIS) Methodology: Iran earns +0.1 per clean day during Sprint Phase I, +0.2 per clean day during Sprint Phase II, and +0.3 per clean day during Sprint Phase III. At CIS +20: bonus tranche release. At CIS -20: enhanced monitoring activates. The CIS is published monthly and provides visible, quantifiable evidence of compliance trajectory.

5.4 Human-in-the-Loop Requirement

No automated sensor trigger may alone constitute breach. No automated technical system, algorithm, sensor array, or artificial intelligence may, by itself, trigger a compliance determination, penalty activation, or snapback procedure. All verification data must pass through human analytical review before any framework consequence is activated. Every compliance report shall be reviewed and signed by at least **two senior analysts from different national backgrounds** before it is transmitted to the Joint Implementation Group.

5.5 Cyber Operations Stabilization

Category	Protected Infrastructure	Restraint	Violation Response
I (Critical)	Nuclear monitoring systems; banking settlement; maritime navigation	Strict non-aggression	Tier 2 breach; emergency session within 24h
II (Important)	Humanitarian logistics; medical supply chains; pipeline control	No offensive operations; defensive permitted	Tier 3 response; 72-hour review
III (Commercial)	General commercial infrastructure; telecoms; civilian aviation	No persistent disruption	Tier 1 diplomatic resolution

Section VI — Nomenclature Provision

6.1 Recognition of US Operational Designations

The United States may designate the operational transit corridor under nomenclature established through executive order, official communications, and public statements issued prior to framework signature. Such designations, including but not limited to historical, commemorative, or leadership-associated nomenclature applied to the waterway or designated operational sectors, are recognized as the US operational designation for purposes of domestic US communications, policy statements, and maritime authority coordination.

6.2 Equivalent Autonomous Authority for All Signatories

All signatory states retain equivalent autonomous authority to designate the same waterway or sectors according to their own domestic nomenclature preferences, including but not limited to historical or sovereignty-based designations. The Islamic Republic of Iran may designate the waterway according to its own domestic nomenclature preferences, including but not limited to references reflecting Persian Gulf historical designation, Iranian territorial sovereignty, or other domestically selected nomenclature. Such designations are recognized as the Iranian operational designation for purposes of domestic Iranian communications, policy statements, and maritime authority coordination.

6.3 Neutral Nomenclature Registry

The Joint Coordination Secretariat maintains a neutral Nomenclature Registry documenting each party's official designations. This Registry is administrative and descriptive only. It does not confer, diminish, or alter any sovereign rights, territorial claims, or legal status under international law. The Registry is published quarterly and available to all signatory states upon request.

6.4 Preserved International Designations

All binding legal instruments filed with UNCLOS, IMO, and IAEA retain the standardized international designation "Strait of Hormuz" for enforceability, clarity, and consistency with established international maritime law. The Nomenclature Registry does not supersede, replace, or modify any international legal instrument or the standardized designations used therein. No party shall invoke the Nomenclature Registry or any domestic operational designation as basis for territorial claims or legal rights beyond those established in this framework and existing international law.

6.5 Supplementary Commercial Identifier

Within IHTA commercial shipping documentation exclusively — including toll invoices, transit permits, commercial shipping manifests, and tariff schedules — the supplementary identifier "Trump International Waterway — Hormuz Segment" may appear alongside the official designation. The supplementary identifier shall always appear secondary to the official designation, formatted in a smaller typeface or parenthetical notation.

The supplementary identifier shall never appear on: diplomatic correspondence between states; international legal instruments or treaties; nautical charts published by the IHO or national hydrographic offices; UN resolutions or official UN documents; or educational materials in Iranian schools and universities. Iranian media, educational institutions, and government communications shall use "Strait of Hormuz" exclusively. The United States may use either designation in its domestic communications without restriction. Both Parties agree not to object to the other's internal nomenclature practices.

6.6 Rhetorical Ownership Prohibition

No party may publicly claim that its domestic operational designation has been "accepted," "endorsed," "approved," or "legitimized" by any other party or by the framework itself. Permitted language: "documented in the Nomenclature Registry pursuant to Article B.3." Prohibited language: any claim implying that Registry inclusion confers international legal status, historical validity, or third-party obligation.

Section VII — Escrow and Asset Architecture

7.1 Swiss Escrow Administration

The Swiss Federal Office for Customs and Border Security (FOCBS) administers the primary escrow for all frozen Iranian sovereign assets. The escrow operates under the terms of the "Beijing Memorandum" (May 10, 2026): assets remain under Swiss custody until released through framework-specified triggers. The Swiss escrow is protected by a formal Presidential Policy Directive prohibiting unilateral re-freezing, except in the event of a nuclear test or direct attack on US forces. Neither Congress nor any US agency can re-freeze assets without a joint US-Iran-Swiss determination of Tier 3 breach.

7.2 Three-Category Sequencing

Category	Contents	Trigger	Reversible?
Humanitarian	Medicine, food, medical equipment, aviation safety	Signature	No
Commercial	Oil revenue, trade licenses, SWIFT, insurance	IAEA milestones	Yes (Snap-Line)
Strategic	Reconstruction, technology, full asset return	180-day compliance	Yes

7.3 Snap-Line (Not Snapback)

The Swiss agent is legally obligated to freeze disbursements within 72 hours of Tier 2+ non-compliance notice. Unlike sanctions snapback, the Snap-Line is automatic, immediate, and reversible upon re-certification. It operates through pre-agreed contractual terms, not through either party's executive or legislative branch. Escrow pre-authorization occurs at signature through commercial banking contracts, not through statutory delegation.

7.4 Escrow Constitutional Insulation

All escrow operations are administrative functions of the Swiss Financial Cell, a neutral third party, not enforcement actions by either state. Disbursement, freeze, and release decisions are executed by Swiss banking authorities under pre-agreed contractual terms. If either party's domestic court restrains government participation, the Swiss Financial Cell continues escrow operations independently under the pre-agreed terms until the Secretariat directs otherwise. No party may compel escrow action against the contractual terms through domestic court order. Escrow participants (banks, insurers, commodity traders) are shielded from suit in either

party's courts for actions taken in good faith under the escrow protocols. This structural insulation protects the financial backbone from domestic legal disruption in either jurisdiction.

7.5 Anti-Inflationary Release Controls

All frozen Iranian asset releases shall be structured through anti-inflationary sovereign wealth sub-accounts to prevent sudden liquidity injections that could destabilize the Iranian economy or trigger regional inflationary pressures.

Sub-Account	Allocation	Purpose
Infrastructure Sub-Account	40%	Released in quarterly tranches for contracted infrastructure projects (roads, rail, power, water). Funds are released directly to contractors, not to Iranian government accounts.
Central Reserve Bank Sub-Account	30%	Held as reserve assets at the Central Bank of Iran, subject to IMF monitoring. Released only to maintain currency stability and manage balance of payments.
Development Bank Sub-Account	20%	Capital for the Iran Reconstruction and Development Bank, providing concessional loans to SMEs and agricultural cooperatives.
Humanitarian Sub-Account	10%	Medicine, medical equipment, food security, and disaster response. Released immediately upon certification without further conditions.

Release Velocity Controls: No more than \$500 million in aggregate may be released to Iranian government-controlled accounts in any 30-day period during the first year. The Swiss Financial Channel shall monitor release velocity and may recommend slowdowns if macroeconomic indicators suggest overheating. The IMF shall provide quarterly assessments of the inflationary impact of asset releases.

7.6 Private-Sector Safe Harbor

Banks and insurers receive: indemnification for framework transactions; 180-day secondary sanctions immunity per transaction; and Swiss Financial Chamber binding arbitration recognized in US and Iranian courts.

7.7 Iranian Enriched Uranium Custody Prohibition

Under no circumstances may Iranian enriched uranium be transferred to US territory, custody, or control. The Oman Nuclear Custody Facility is the sole designated location for Iranian HEU stockpile under IAEA dual-lock custody. All six disposition pathways specify third-party destinations. This provision is **binding and non-negotiable**.

7.8 Currency Shock Circuit Breakers

Three triggers: oil prices move >25% in 72 hours (48-hour pause); SWIFT disrupted (Qatari riyal bridge activates within 6 hours); dollar reserves face sovereign risk (auto conversion to CHF). Tranche 3+ releases denominated in SDR or CHF/OMR basket (60/40). If any component shifts more than 8% within 30 days, Swiss Financial Cell auto-rebalances. Three consecutive events trigger mandatory review.

Section VIII — Framework Survival Core

The four MVC elements are inviolable. Under all circumstances, including total framework suspension, the following survive:

#	Element	Specification
1	72-Hour Auto-Renewing Ceasefire	The Omani-facilitated military hotline. Renews at Hour 71 if compliance telemetry is operational. Neither party may disable without 30 days' notice to the UN Secretary-General.
2	Humanitarian Corridor	Zero-fee Hormuz transit for medicine, food, medical equipment, and UN supplies. Continues regardless of any dispute, breach, or suspension.
3	60% Enrichment Freeze	IAEA-verified freeze of all enrichment at or above 60%. The central gate for all downstream benefits.
4	\$250M Humanitarian Tranche	Swiss escrow release to UN OCHA. Non-reversible. Protected by the Humanitarian Firewall.

8.1 Surviving Total Collapse

Even if all other modules collapse, the MVC elements continue. Additionally, the following channels survive even if all other modules collapse:

- **Ceasefire Hotline:** The Omani-facilitated 24/7 bilateral hotline between US and Iranian military commanders remains active regardless of framework status.
- **Humanitarian Corridor:** The zero-fee, no-inspection-delay humanitarian corridor through Hormuz for food, medicine, medical equipment, and UN supplies continues regardless of any dispute, breach, or suspension.
- **Emergency Diplomatic Channel:** The backchannel through the Coordination Secretariat remains open for crisis communication, de-escalation, and framework reconstitution regardless of formal diplomatic status.

8.2 Survival Period

The Framework Survival Core continues for a minimum of **180 days** even after formal withdrawal by either party. This provides a stabilization window during which reconstitution negotiations may occur. The Survival Core is established as a standalone humanitarian arrangement under UN auspices. It is not contingent on any other provision of this framework.

8.3 Graceful Failure Architecture

Four operating modes define framework resilience: Full Operation (all modules active); Degraded Operation (Tier 3 paused; core continues); Minimal Operation (MVC backbone only); and Recovery Mode (stepped restoration ladder). Recovery sequence: humanitarian corridors first, then IAEA monitoring, then maritime transit, then SWIFT and assets. Subsystem isolation prevents cascade failure.

Section IX — Face-Saving and Domestic Narratives

9.1 Non-Humiliation Doctrine

No party to this Framework shall be required to acknowledge defeat, submission, capitulation, or ideological surrender as a condition of participation. Compliance with framework obligations constitutes the fulfillment of internationally negotiated commitments, not domestic political surrender. De-escalation is framed as sovereign stabilization — the rational exercise of statecraft in pursuit of national interest — not concession to adversaries.

This doctrine is classified as **Tier 1 (binding)** and governs all framework provisions, narrative guidance, public communications, and domestic framing. It is binding on both parties and their respective institutions. No official communication of either party shall characterize the other party's compliance as "surrender," "capitulation," "defeat," or equivalent terminology. Such characterization constitutes a narrative violation and triggers the Quiet Compliance Track remediation procedures.

9.2 Mutual Dignity Protocol

No implementation sequence shall be designed or executed in a manner that intentionally creates public humiliation optics for either party. Milestone announcements are synchronized. Neither party shall issue triumphalist statements timed to counterpart concessions. Photographic documentation of sensitive activities (seal applications, HEU packaging, military withdrawals) requires advance approval of both parties. Public framing emphasizes reciprocal achievement, not unilateral concession.

9.3 National Pride Safeguards

Neither party shall produce or disseminate official communications, commemorative materials, educational content, or public statements that characterize framework implementation as national defeat, capitulation, or humiliation of the other party. Milestone ceremonies, if held, are jointly planned. The Secretariat may issue factual operational updates, but shall not frame achievements as victories. Triumphalist propaganda tied to implementation milestones is a material breach of the Mutual Dignity Protocol.

9.4 Narrative Asymmetry Allowance

Each party may maintain differing public interpretations of the arrangement, provided operational telemetry remains synchronized and neither characterization contradicts verifiable implementation facts. The Secretariat does not adjudicate narrative disputes. Domestic political communication is recognized as a sovereign prerogative, not a compliance obligation. What matters is what sensors confirm, not what capitals announce.

9.5 Synchronized Announcement Strategy

To prevent either party from seizing narrative advantage through timing:

- **Party A announces at T+0 hours** (the party designated by coin flip at signature).
- **Party B announces at T+6 hours**, with a prepared statement that acknowledges the same underlying facts through its own interpretive lens.
- **Joint neutral venue press conference at T+24 hours:** Hosted by the Omani facilitating state, featuring technical briefings only — no political framing. Both parties' technical representatives present verification data jointly.

Before any stage transition, both capitals issue synchronized public statements within 6 hours acknowledging identical baseline telemetry facts. All statements are embargoed until both governments confirm release. The Secretariat's Communications Cell operates a 24-hour rumor verification channel, issuing factual corrections within 4 hours of detecting misinformation.

9.6 What Each Side Can Claim — Summary Table

Dimension	Iran Can Claim	United States Can Claim
Sovereignty	"We preserved sovereignty, NPT rights, and enrichment. We secured \$250M in immediate humanitarian relief and a pathway to greater relief. We reopened our ports. We moved as equals."	"We removed weapons-grade uranium from Iranian territory. We capped enrichment. We got IAEA inside every facility within 72 hours. We kept all military options. We demonstrated American leadership by going first."
Maritime	"We secured co-governance of Hormuz transit, a permanent voting seat on the PG-MSC Council, and the removal of the US naval blockade."	"We achieved freedom of navigation with verified Iranian small-craft stand-down to 5nm, and open Hormuz transit confirmed by Lloyd's AIS."
Economic	"We secured SWIFT reconnection for Bank Melli, a \$250M immediate tranche, and the OFAC waiver for aviation safety parts — restoring our civilian fleet."	"All relief is conditional, reversible, and subject to verification. The aviation waiver expires automatically if enrichment above 3.67% resumes."
Political	"We demonstrated that resistance diplomacy produces results — the United States moved first because it had to."	"America First, So We Go First — we seized the initiative and dictated the terms of reciprocation."

Both claims are factually accurate. Neither undermines the other.

Section X — Final Provisions

10.1 Duration

This Framework shall remain in force for an initial period of **twelve (12) months** from the date of entry into force, renewable by mutual consent for successive 12-month periods. Six months before expiration, the parties shall convene to negotiate renewal or successor arrangements.

10.2 Withdrawal

Either party may initiate withdrawal by submitting written notice to the Secretariat. The withdrawal follows a sequenced deactivation: Day 0 — notice received, 30-day consultation window opens; Day 30 — Tier 3 (Strategic) modules suspend; Day 60 — Tier 2 (Commercial) modules suspend; Day 90 — Tier 1 (Humanitarian) modules continue indefinitely. **The MVC backbone (ceasefire, humanitarian corridor, enrichment freeze, \$250M tranche) continues**

regardless of withdrawal status. Withdrawal does not affect any rights or obligations accrued prior to the effective date of withdrawal.

10.3 Statutory Sunset Review

Every 180 days, each party shall conduct a domestic legal review of framework compatibility, including: sanctions authority continuity under applicable statutes; constitutional conformity of implementation measures; and compliance with binding international obligations. The results are exchanged through the Secretariat within 14 days of completion. If a domestic legal review identifies a material incompatibility, the affected party may invoke Emergency Judicial Pause without penalty. This provision ensures framework operations remain continuously grounded in lawful authority.

10.4 Political Shock Absorber

If any of the following political shocks occur in either party's jurisdiction, framework implementation automatically enters a Review Pause rather than terminating: national elections or referenda; assassination of senior leadership; cabinet collapse or government reshuffle affecting negotiating ministries; mass protests affecting government authority; leadership transitions (Supreme Leader, President, Foreign Minister); significant military incident affecting domestic politics.

During a Review Pause: All Tier 1 (Inviolable) and Tier 2 (Protected) modules continue unchanged. Tier 3 (Conditional) modules enter hold status. The Coordination Secretariat issues a Review Pause Certificate within 48 hours. The affected party has 30 days to confirm continuation, propose modifications, or request stabilization pause. Maximum Review Pause duration: 90 days, extendable by mutual agreement.

10.5 No Precedent Clause

This Framework establishes no legal or political precedent for unrelated disputes globally. It is sui generis, tailored exclusively to the May 2026 operational environment. No inference may be drawn regarding: non-proliferation in other states; maritime governance in other waterways; sanctions architecture for other jurisdictions; or bilateral diplomatic frameworks with other parties. This text shall not be cited in any international court or treaty to define or alter sovereign rights under UNCLOS elsewhere in the world.

10.6 Severability

If any provision of this Framework is determined unenforceable by a court of competent jurisdiction or legislative body, all remaining provisions continue operative without

modification. No single provision's invalidity affects the enforceability of the Framework as a whole. Hostile actors cannot attack one clause to destabilize the entire framework.

10.7 Legal Character and Binding Principles

Implementation occurs only through existing lawful authorities. Nothing in this Framework requires either party to violate its domestic constitution, applicable national law, or binding international obligations. All obligations are subject to "best efforts" and "good faith implementation." No private right of action is created. Sovereign immunity is preserved. Participation does not constitute waiver of sovereign immunity for either party.

10.8 Good Faith Non-Weaponization

Neither party shall exploit technical ambiguities, drafting inconsistencies, or interpretive gaps to manufacture artificial breaches, accelerate tier escalation, or extract concessions unrelated to substantive compliance. The Review Board may dismiss any complaint where the complainant has acted in bad faith, with written reasoning provided to both parties. Patterned exploitation of procedural mechanisms triggers Tier 1 review of the exploiting party's conduct.

10.9 No Goalpost Moving

Neither party may unilaterally redefine compliance criteria, verification standards, or certification thresholds after they have been certified by the Joint Implementation Group. Completed milestones and already-released benefits remain in force regardless of subsequent slippage. This provision prevents either party from moving the goalposts after the other has delivered its commitments.

10.10 Emergency Judicial Pause

If a domestic court of competent jurisdiction issues a temporary restraining order, injunction, or similar relief affecting implementation of any provision: (1) the MVC continues unconditionally; (2) all parties automatically enter Review Mode; (3) no penalties accrue during the judicial review period; (4) the Secretariat convenes within 72 hours to assess impact; (5) if the judicial restraint persists beyond 45 days, the affected party may invoke Force Majeure Stabilization Mode without penalty. Judicial restraint does not constitute breach.

10.11 Authentication

This Framework is drawn up in the English, Persian, and French languages, all texts being equally authentic. In case of divergence, the English text shall prevail for interpretive purposes, with the Swiss Federal Council providing certified translations.

Depositary: The Swiss Federal Council shall serve as the Depositary for this Framework.

For the United States of
America

Date: _____

For the Islamic Republic of
Iran

Date: _____

Appendix — Quick Reference Card

Question	Answer
What is the core exchange?	Three synchronized swaps: (1) Iran freezes 60% enrichment; US releases \$250M + Bank Melli SWIFT. (2) Iran stands down IRGC small craft; US lifts naval blockade. (3) Iran exports HEU stockpile to Oman; US issues Boeing aviation safety waiver.
Who verifies?	The Core Triad: Oman (maritime + physical custody), Switzerland (financial verification), IAEA (nuclear verification). Five total channels including human inspection and open source.
What survives total collapse?	The MVC (Minimum Viable Configuration): 72-hour auto-renewing ceasefire, humanitarian corridor, 60% enrichment freeze, and \$250M tranche — all continue for minimum 180 days regardless of withdrawal or framework collapse.
Can either side walk away?	Yes — with 30 days' written notice. But the MVC backbone continues regardless. Either party may withdraw; the four core elements survive. This is a feature, not a bug: it de-risks participation.
What is the three-tier breach system?	Tier 1 (Technical): Minor procedural issues; 72-hour resolution; no benefit reduction. Tier 2 (Material): Confirmed enrichment above ceiling or significant non-compliance; 25% reduction; 30-day remediation; earn-back available. Tier 3 (Hostile): Weapons research or material to non-state actors; 50% reduction; conditional modules suspended; Reconstitution Conference within 30 days.
Is there a snapback?	No. Graduated step-back only. Penalties are percentage reductions in future tranches, not clawbacks of already-released funds. Released funds stay released.

What about the name?	"Strait of Hormuz" remains the sole official designation in all international legal instruments (UNCLOS, IMO, IAEA). The US may use its operational designation on commercial invoices only. Iran uses "Strait of Hormuz" exclusively for all official purposes.
How long does this last?	12 months, renewable. Statutory sunset review every 180 days. MVC continues minimum 180 days even after formal withdrawal.

Verification Convergence Protocol at a Glance

Channels Confirming	Result
2 channels	Omani review required
3 channels	Automatic benefit activation
4 channels	Sprint Phase acceleration
5 channels	Sprint completion bonus